

Figure 2: S.V. Nallaperumal Pillai

Evidently, the local merchants, angered by the attitude of BI, rallied around S.V. Nallaperumal Pillai who was then a young man of twenty-five. It is probable that the new arrangement—perhaps not formally registered—functioned in the name of the pre-existing firm of Sena Vana Company. VOC's contemporary letter also refers to Sena Vana, as do reports in Bharati's *India* and other papers.[22] From VOC's letter it appears that four merchants joined hands—their identities are not known—with Sena Vana Company.[23] SSNCo itself, in fact, described its previous avatar as 'a syndicate'—presumably meaning that it was not a registered entity.[24]

Curiously, despite the initial lead taken by S.V. Nallaperumal Pillai, his name recedes into the background from early 1907, only to make a brief appearance in May 1909 (of which later). Ironically, his is one of the few names to be remembered while people with more substantial contributions and sacrifices have been forgotten.

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While most contemporary documents refer to April 1906 as the time when the first stirrings of the Swadeshi shipping enterprise were noticed, other